Paul Skenes

PIT · RHP · Starter · Age 24 · 2,890 pitches · 32 G

Pitcher evaluation
2026 regular season
Data through **2026-09-27**
MLBAM 694973

IP	ERA	FIP	XFIP	XERA	K%	BB%	K-BB%	CSW%	WHIFF%	CHASE%	FB VELO
174.1	3.82	3.33	3.41	3.28	28.1%	6.9%	21.2%	26.7%	25.8%	32.3%	96.8

BOTTOM LINE

1. **Strong run prevention by xERA:** 3.82 ERA, 3.28 xERA (83rd pct), 3.33 FIP, 21.2% K-BB.
2. **Best pitch: four-seam (50 Stuff / 65 Results):** 27.1% whiff, .290 xwOBA, 41% usage.
3. **Opportunity in 0-0 vs LHH:** throws four-seam 42%; the situational model prefers slider (.246 vs .265 expected xwOBA, n=414).
4. **Tunnel pair FS/SL:** 1.4 in apart at the decision point, 10.2 in at the plate (7.1× late separation).

20–80 GRADES

vs 424 pitchers ≥600 pitches

Stuff	50	+0.06 RV/100
Command	55	BB 6.9%
Bat-missing	55	Whiff 26%
Contact mgmt	50	xwOBAcon .347
Durability	55	IP/GS 5.4

ARSENAL Arsenal — splitter is the best pitch by shape (55 Stuff, above-average)

Velo mph · spin rpm · IVB/HB inches, catcher view (HB + = toward 1B) · Ext ft · Whiff per swing · Chase = swing % outside zone · xwOBA per PA ended · RV/100 = count-neutral run value per 100 pitches, + = good for pitcher · cells tinted by percentile within pitch type & hand · grey rows: n < 100

		USAGE			USAGE BY COUNT				SHAPE					RESULTS					GRADES (20–80)		
PITCH	N	ALL	VL	VR	0-0	AHD	BHD	2K	VELO	SPIN	IVB	HB	EXT	WHIFF	CHASE	CSW	XWOBA	RV/100	STUFF	RES	CMD
Four-seam FF	1180	**41%**	45%	35%	37%	43%	45%	40%	96.8	2176	13.0	-12.6	6.8	27%	33%	28%	.290	+0.4	50	65	55
Sweeper ST	460	**16%**	8%	27%	22%	17%	12%	14%	84.3	2333	5.7	10.2	6.7	27%	23%	33%	.226	+1.0	50	55	50
Changeup CH	360	**12%**	17%	6%	8%	17%	7%	20%	88.7	1820	6.5	-15.4	6.7	35%	38%	20%	.246	-1.6	40	55	45
Sinker SI	340	**12%**	8%	18%	16%	8%	13%	9%	96.6	2154	7.3	-17.0	6.7	12%	26%	28%	.311	+0.2	50	55	65
Splitter FS	291	**10%**	13%	6%	13%	5%	15%	4%	93.2	1638	1.7	-13.3	6.7	17%	36%	19%	.338	+0.6	55	35	70
Slider SL	249	**9%**	8%	9%	4%	10%	8%	13%	86.7	2317	1.9	3.3	6.8	32%	39%	27%	.258	+1.8	45	50	45

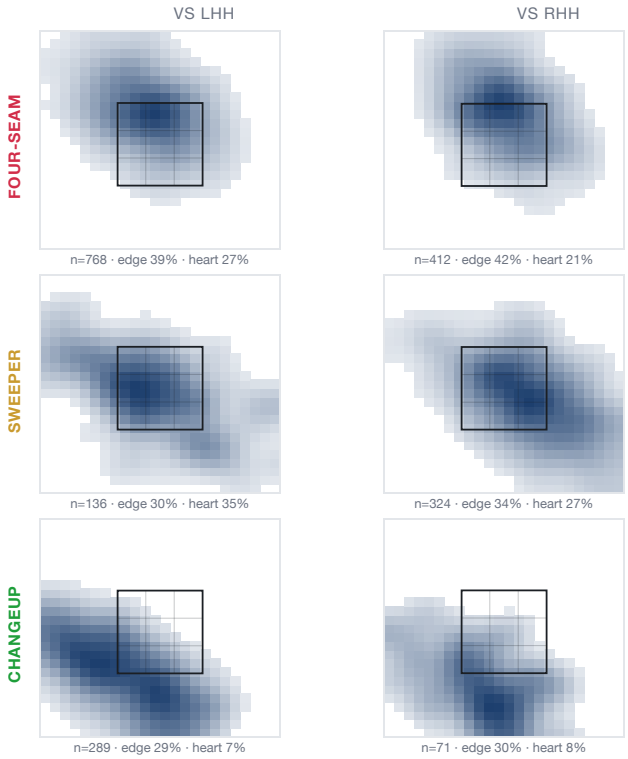
SHAPE Movement — four-seam carries 2.6 in less IVB than the average RHP four-seam

Dots = individual pitches (≤110 per type); large markers = his averages; dashed ellipses = league 1-SD shape for the same pitch type from RHPs. Inches, catcher view.



LOCATION Location — 71% of his four-seams finish in the upper third or above

Smoothed density of pitch locations (catcher view; box = average rule-book zone, thirds marked). Darker = more frequent (frequency, not quality) · edge = within ±3 in of the zone border.



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COUNTS Count strategy — most predictable in 3-1 vs LHH (56% four-seam)

Throws most = his most-used pitch in each count (tint: red = mixed, blue = ≥70% one pitch, i.e. predictable). Model pick = lowest expected xwOBA from the situational model vs a league-average hitter (◆ = differs). Mix gap = his actual mix's model xwOBA minus the model pick's, in points (.001); blue = larger opportunity.

VS LHH	0-0	1-0	2-0	3-0	0-1	1-1	2-1	3-1	0-2	1-2	2-2	3-2
Throws most	FF 42% n=414	FF 49% n=173	FS 40% n=60	FF 90% n=20	FF 51% n=202	FF 48% n=163	FF 41% n=91	FF 56% n=43	FF 50% n=111	FF 47% n=183	FF 38% n=138	FF 38% n=90
Model pick	SL ◆	SL ◆	SL ◆	ST ◆	SL ◆	SL ◆	SL ◆	SL ◆	SL ◆	SL ◆	SL ◆	ST ◆
Mix gap (pts)	16	17	18	19	6	10	11	24	4	7	12	18

VS RHH	0-0	1-0	2-0	3-0	0-1	1-1	2-1	3-1	0-2	1-2	2-2	3-2
Throws most	FF 30% n=297	FF 39% n=98	FF 36% n=36	FF 86% n=7	FF 35% n=168	FF 32% n=111	FF 38% n=53	FF 41% n=17	FF 39% n=85	FF 34% n=143	FF 33% n=113	FF 42% n=64
Model pick	SL ◆	SL ◆	SL ◆	ST ◆	SL ◆	SL ◆	SL ◆	SL ◆	SL ◆	SL ◆	SL ◆	ST ◆
Mix gap (pts)	16	17	20	15	6	9	12	24	4	7	12	13

MOST PREDICTABLE

3-1 vs LHH · **56% FF** n=43
0-1 vs LHH · **51% FF** n=202
0-2 vs LHH · **50% FF** n=111

LARGEST MODEL GAPS

0-0 vs LHH · FF 42% → **SL** .265→.246
0-0 vs RHH · FF 30% → **SL** .258→.239
1-0 vs LHH · FF 49% → **SL** .266→.247

SEQUENCE Sequencing — FS/SL is the best tunnel pair (7.1× separation after the decision point)

Share (%) of next pitch within the same PA, by previous pitch. Tunnel = mean trajectories 23.8 ft from the plate vs at the plate.

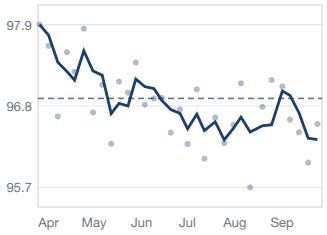
AFTER ↓ / NEXT →	FF	ST	CH	SI	FS	SL
FF n=884	51	12	13	6	7	11
ST n=378	39	23	10	15	7	5
CH n=265	41	8	24	8	9	9
SI n=245	27	18	14	20	9	13
FS n=216	36	10	13	11	25	5
SL n=173	38	14	13	10	3	21

Best tunnel: **FS/SL** — 1.4 in apart at the decision point, 10.2 in apart at the plate (7.1× late separation; release 0.7 in apart)
Four-seam after CH: **33% whiff** vs 27% overall (72 swings)
Splitter after FF: **17% whiff** vs 17% overall (35 swings)

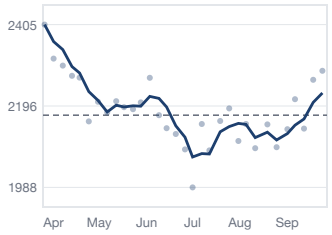
TRENDS Trends — stable through the season

Per game (dots), 3-game rolling mean (line), dashed = baseline before last 5 games; ⚑ shaded = flagged window (≥1 mph, 75 rpm or 0.2 ft). No IL stints.

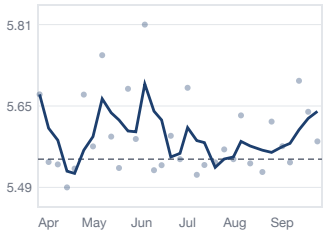
Primary FB velo (mph)



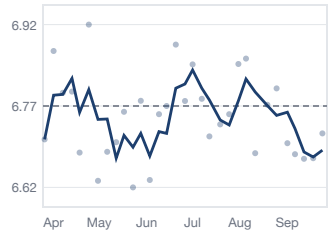
Primary FB spin (rpm)



Release height (ft)



Extension (ft)



SPLITS Splits — LHH do more damage (39-pt xwOBA gap)

Statcast PAs, regular season. xwOBA tint vs league .315 (red = better for him). Times through order use the batter's PA count vs this pitcher in the game. Velo hold: primary FB -0.3 mph on pitches 76+ vs 1–25. Grey rows: < 60 PA.

SPLIT	PA	WOBA	XWOBA	K%	BB%	HR	WHIFF	CHASE
vs LHH	413	.304	.297	26.9%	8.2%	13	26%	32%
vs RHH	296	.298	.258	30.1%	5.1%	7	25%	33%
1st time	285	.300	.290	31.2%	7.7%	12	28%	32%
2nd time	277	.279	.271	26.4%	7.9%	5	23%	32%
3rd+ time	147	.348	.282	25.9%	3.4%	3	28%	34%

COMPS Comps — closest arsenal profile: Ryan Weathers

Nearest neighbors among qualified pitchers on pitch mix, primary-FB velo/IVB/HB, arm angle, breaking-ball shape and separation, whiff% and zone% (standardized, weighted). Chip = comp's Stuff grade.

Ryan Weathers NYY 45 — 56% similar
LHP SP · FB 95.8 mph, 15" IVB · CH 25% / FF 22% / SI 21% / ST 20% / SL 12%

Seranthony Domínguez SEA 55 — 55% similar
RHP RP · FB 97.3 mph, 14" IVB · FF 43% / ST 28% / SI 16% / FS 11%

Chase Dollander COL 60 — 54% similar
RHP RP · FB 98.9 mph, 13" IVB · FF 38% / SI 24% / SL 15% / CH 10%

DEVELOP Development notes — usage direction from the arsenal optimizer

Constrained optimizer on the outcome model (each pitch ±15 pts, 3–55% bounds). Expected gains are small and model-dependent: hypotheses for the pitching staff, not prescriptions.

vs LHH: SL 8→23%, ST 8→23%, FF 45→30% (model xwOBA -4 pts, n=1688)
vs RHH: FF 35→20%, ST 27→42%, SL 9→24% (model xwOBA -3 pts, n=1192)
Shape: his changeup grades 40 Stuff. Top-quartile RHP changeups average 9.5 in of vertical separation from the fastball vs his 6.5 — the largest gap; worth a look in pitch design, not a prescription.

Grades. each scale is a z-score composite converted to a percentile within the qualified pool, then 50 + 10·Φ⁻¹(p), clipped 20–80 and shown to the nearest 5. Pitch grades are within the same pitch type and throwing hand (≥100 pitches). Stuff = a gradient-boosted model of expected, count-neutral run value from velo, movement, spin, extension, release, arm angle and separation from the primary fastball (no location or results; held-out pitch-type correlation r=0.37). Results = whiff%, CSW%, xwOBA. Command = edge%, waste%, heart% (pitch) and BB%, edge, zone, first-strike (overall). Durability = IP/start, pitches/game, late-game velo hold (relievers: G, IP). **Models.** count plan = situational pitch-type model (2026, generic league-average hitter, medium leverage, 2nd time through); location/tunneling from Statcast trajectory fits at a 23.8 ft decision point; usage suggestion = constrained arsenal optimizer (±15 pts/pitch). Model gaps are small effects — treat as direction. **Caveats.** single season, regular season only; small-sample cells greyed; xwOBA ignores park and defense; IL dates from MLB transactions (retroactive dates honored).